

Did the Pharaoh of the exodus survive the Red sea crossing?

History, and even some “christian” sources, claim that the Pharaoh of the exodus survived the Red sea crossing. They offer compelling “evidence” such as the date on a wine juglet in Amenhotep II’s Theban funerary temple, Amenhotep II’s *estimated* lifespan from xrays of his mummified corpse, Thutmose IV’s Lateran Obelisk, and more.

But, what does God’s word tell us?

Exodus 9:13-15

13 And the LORD said unto Moses, Rise up early in the morning, and stand before **Pharaoh**, and say unto **him**, Thus saith the LORD God of the Hebrews, Let my people go, that they may serve me.
14 For I will at this time send all my plagues upon **thine** heart, and upon **thy** servants, and upon **thy** people; that **thou** mayest know that there is none like me in all the earth.
15 For now I will stretch out my hand, that I may smite **thee** and **thy** people with pestilence; and **thou shalt be cut off from the earth.**

After the 6th judgment against the gods of Egypt (**Exo 12:12**) the LORD speaking to Pharaoh through Moses pronounces that “thou [Pharaoh] shalt be cut off from the earth”. If you weren’t already aware, the phrase “cut off from the earth” means that Pharaoh is going to die. Since here the LORD doesn’t tell us how or when that will happen we must continue onward to find that.

Exodus 12:33-37

33 And the Egyptians were urgent upon the people, that they might send them out of the land in haste; for they said, We *be* all dead *men*.
34 And the people took their dough before it was leavened, their kneadingtroughs being bound up in their clothes upon their shoulders.
35 And the children of Israel did according to the word of Moses; and they borrowed of the Egyptians jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and raiment:
36 And the LORD gave the people favour in the sight of the Egyptians, so that they lent unto them *such things as they required*. And they spoiled the Egyptians.
37 And the children of Israel journeyed from Rameses to Succoth, about six hundred thousand on foot *that were men*, beside children.

Exodus 13:20

And they took their journey from Succoth, and encamped in Etham, in the edge of the wilderness.

Exodus 14:2-4

2 Speak unto the children of Israel, that they turn and encamp before Pi-hahiroth, between Migdol and the sea, **over against Baal-zephon**: before it shall ye encamp by the sea.
3 For Pharaoh will say of the **children of Israel**, They *are* entangled in the land, the wilderness hath shut them in.
4 And I will harden Pharaoh's heart, that **he shall follow after** them; and **I will be honoured upon Pharaoh**, and upon all his host; **that the Egyptians may know that I am the LORD**. And they did so.

After the exodus of the children of Israel from Egypt begins, we learn about where they traveled. Interestingly, the LORD leads them to a place that led Pharaoh to believe that they were trapped by the land. But, more importantly for the question at hand, we are told that Pharaoh will follow after them (the children of Israel).

Exodus 14:5-28

- ⁵ And it was told the king of Egypt that the people fled: and the heart of Pharaoh and of his servants was turned against the people, and they said, Why have we done this, that we have let Israel go from serving us?
- ⁶ And he made ready his chariot, and took his people with him:
- ⁷ And he took six hundred chosen chariots, and all the chariots of Egypt, and captains over every one of them.
- ⁸ And the LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh king of Egypt, and he pursued after the children of Israel: and the children of Israel went out with an high hand.
- ⁹ But the Egyptians pursued after them, all the horses and chariots of Pharaoh, and his horsemen, and his army, and overtook them encamping by the sea, beside Pi-hahiroth, before Baal-zephon.
- ¹⁰ And when Pharaoh drew nigh, the children of Israel lifted up their eyes, and, behold, the Egyptians marched after them; and they were sore afraid: and the children of Israel cried out unto the LORD.

In v6,7,9 we learn that Pharaoh (also known as the king of Egypt) and his people are what comprise “the Egyptians” that followed after the children of Israel.

In v10 we learn that Pharaoh came close enough to the children of Israel that they saw him and his army, and then they cried out unto the LORD.

Exodus 14:17-28

- ¹⁷ And I, behold, I will harden the hearts of the Egyptians, and they shall follow them: and I will get me honour upon Pharaoh, and upon all his host, upon his chariots, and upon his horsemen.
- ¹⁸ And the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD, when I have gotten me honour upon Pharaoh, upon his chariots, and upon his horsemen.
- ¹⁹ And the angel of God, which went before the camp of Israel, removed and went behind them; and the pillar of the cloud went from before their face, and stood behind them:
- ²⁰ And it came between the camp of the Egyptians and the camp of Israel; and it was a cloud and darkness to them, but it gave light by night to these: so that the one came not near the other all the night.
- ²¹ And Moses stretched out his hand over the sea; and the LORD caused the sea to go back by a strong east wind all that night, and made the sea dry land, and the waters were divided.
- ²² And the children of Israel went into the midst of the sea upon the dry ground: and the waters were a wall unto them on their right hand, and on their left.
- ²³ And the Egyptians pursued, and went in after them to the midst of the sea, even all Pharaoh's horses, his chariots, and his horsemen.
- ²⁴ And it came to pass, that in the morning watch the LORD looked unto the host of the Egyptians through the pillar of fire and of the cloud, and troubled the host of the Egyptians,
- ²⁵ And took off their chariot wheels, that they drave them heavily: so that the Egyptians said, Let us flee from the face of Israel; for the LORD fighteth for them against the Egyptians.
- ²⁶ And the LORD said unto Moses, Stretch out thine hand over the sea, that the waters may come again upon the Egyptians, upon their chariots, and upon their horsemen.
- ²⁷ And Moses stretched forth his hand over the sea, and the sea returned to his strength when the morning appeared; and the Egyptians fled against it; and the LORD overthrew the Egyptians in the midst of the sea.
- ²⁸ And the waters returned, and covered the chariots, and the horsemen, and all the host of Pharaoh that came into the sea after them; there remained not so much as one of them.

Remember that up until this point the plagues in Egypt had decimated their crops and their livestock. After the 7th plague (thunder, hail, and fire) and before the 8th plague (locusts) even Pharaoh's servants admitted that Egypt was “destroyed” (Exo 10:7). What's left for God to get honour upon? That which hotly pursued after the children of Israel: the leadership and the army.

Remember the chariot that Pharaoh made ready and led his army after the children of Israel with in Exo 14:6?

The song of Moses and the children of Israel after the Red sea crossing (Exo 15:1-21)

Exodus 15:19

For **the horse of Pharaoh** went in **with** his chariots and **with** his horsemen into the sea, and the LORD brought again the waters of the sea upon them; but the children of Israel went on dry land in the midst of the sea.

Where does it say that Pharaoh got off of his chariot and waited on the bank of the Red sea while everyone else went ahead and he survived? Spoiler: you won't find it because it didn't happen.

Where else in the Bible can we find the fulfillment of **Exodus 9:15** concerning Pharaoh?

And as if that wasn't enough...

Psalms 136:10-15

- ¹⁰ **To him that smote Egypt in their firstborn**: for his mercy endureth for ever:
- ¹¹ And brought out Israel from among them: for his mercy endureth for ever:
- ¹² With a strong hand, and with a stretched out arm: for his mercy endureth for ever.
- ¹³ To him which divided the Red sea into parts: for his mercy endureth for ever:
- ¹⁴ And made Israel to pass through the midst of it: for his mercy endureth for ever:
- ¹⁵ But overthrew Pharaoh and his host in the Red sea: for his mercy endureth for ever.